7. Different backgrounds of two individuals may result in differences in the interpretation and understanding of a message.
8. In-group language, often used by different occupational or social groups, may be a potential barrier to communication.

7.20 How to overcome the Barriers to Communication

To improve the communication skills a manager should try the following.

1. Use simple and clear language, remember that everyone in the organisation should understand.
2. Be an active, attentive listener, or otherwise you will tend to miss valuable information.
3. Avoid information overload, as people have a limited capacity to process information and a major amount of information gets lost because of that. That is why one should pass only as much information can be attended to.
4. Give and receive feedback, as soon as possible.
5. Nurture the relationship and create an atmosphere of trust, for open and free communication in the organisation.

Points to Remember

- Leadership is a quality of behaviour of individuals by which they can influence others. Influencing others for the organisational objectives is a important element in leadership.
- Leaders may arise from a formal organisational setup and in an informal setup.
- Leadership characteristics include personal quality, influence, continuous process and situation.
- Importance of leadership include Motivating employees , Creating confidence, Building Morale, Initiates action, Builds work environment, co-ordination.
- Leader leads the group where else manager manages the group.
- Qualities of Leadership includes physical energy and stamina, Intelligence, vision and foresight, Initiative, self-confidence, open mindedness, sense of responsibility and human relations.
- Leadership style denotes a specific behaviour a person exhibits in order to influence people and achieve organisational goals.
- Different types of Leadership styles include Autocratic, Democratic, Laissez fair, functional, Institutional, paternalistic and charismatic styles.
- All leaders can be a manager also but all managers cannot be leader.
- Communication is a process by which information is exchanged between individuals through a common system of symbols, signs of behaviour.
- The term process refers to identifiable flow of information through interrelated stages of analysis directed towards the achievement of an objective.
- Feedback is necessary to ensure that the receiver has received the message and understands it in the same sense as the sender wants, that is, the message has been received, decoded properly accepted and used.
- Formal communications are those which flow through formally established channels as depicted in the formal organizational chart, and are concerned with work related matters.
- Grapevines are mostly oral, though at times an individual may send emails to one of his friends located elsewhere.

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